

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's start planning our event!



Learning Outcome

Present advice on solving technical problems in a work context and appropriate for the interlocutor.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can change topics during a conversation.
- I can describe how things happen.

Ask your partner:

- What's the latest news about your workplace? What are people talking about?
- How do you change the subject when having a chat in the office?





Let's Explore!

Miranda and Ferdinand **get the ball rolling*** for the event.

* To "get the ball rolling" is a business expression that means to make something start happening.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Ferdinand:** Miranda? How is life in Boston?
- Miranda:** Unexpectedly busy. Let's catch up on that later. How are things in Brazil?
- Ferdinand:** Things are going supremely well here. I have successfully connected with some associates in Colombia too.
- Miranda:** Great. Now, to change the subject, I'm holding a meeting this week to discuss our PR event. Oh, that reminds me, do you have access to a webcam?
- Ferdinand:** Hold on to that question ... have you got an event date yet? I have an idea ...
- Miranda:** What's that?
- Ferdinand:** Sao Paulo Fashion Week is just around the corner. Let's host the events simultaneously! We could have a big screen to broadcast the events.
- Miranda:** Ferdinand, I believe you're charmed. Hope your good luck will quickly head north. Getting back to your schedule ...
- Ferdinand:** Thursday afternoon is my only opening this week.
- Miranda:** I'll schedule the meeting then.
- Ferdinand:** Thanks. Oh, before I forget, what bad news do you keep repeatedly hinting at?
- Miranda:** Only a leak over social media about massive layoffs at Holly's.
- Ferdinand:** What? A layoff leak? What's going on?
- Miranda:** Farmani is trying hard to cut expenses wherever he can. But don't worry. Janet's carefully designing a plan. It will turn things around.
- Ferdinand:** I'm awfully glad to hear that. I will be in touch Thursday then!





Let's Practice!

Miranda and Ferdinand have a chat, but they keep changing topics.

Instructions: Number the sentences 1 - 9 in the correct order. Say the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- ___ 1 Ferdinand: Miranda, how's life in Boston?
- ___ Miranda: No. What do you suggest?
- ___ Miranda: Unexpectedly busy. Let's catch up on that later. How are things in Brazil?
- ___ Ferdinand: We could do it during the Sao Paulo Fashion week.
- ___ Miranda: Great. Now, to change the subject, I'm holding a meeting to discuss the event.
- ___ Miranda: Oh that reminds me, do you have access to a webcam?
- ___ Ferdinand: Ok. We can do this now.
- ___ Ferdinand: Things are going supremely well here.
- ___ Ferdinand: Hold on to that question, but have you got an event date yet?



Let's Practice!

Miranda and Ferdinand work diligently* to plan the event.

*"Diligently": means to work very hard and very carefully.

Instructions: Unscramble the letters. Write the correct adverbs in the sentences.

- | | |
|---|----------------|
| 1. I've been _____ busy. | edexypncteu |
| 2. Janet's _____ designing a plan. | clyafulre |
| 3. Farmani is trying _____ to cut expenses. | rhda |
| 4. Let's host the events _____. | tasiymnloueusl |
| 5. I have _____ connected with some associates. | cslyucesulsf |





Extension Activity

How well do you perform at work? Assess your work performance.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think of verbs or actions to describe things you do in your workplace (call, type, write, etc.) and write them down.
- Go online and research "adverbs of manner".
- Write down a list of 5-10 adverbs of manner on the same paper with the verbs and actions.
- Now, choose a verb on your list and describe how you do that in the workplace using one of the adverbs from your research.
For example: *type - I type quickly*
- Change topics and talk about other actions in the workplace.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I write verbs to describe what I do in the workplace.

☐ ☐

I research adverbs of manner.

☐ ☐

I write adverbs that describe how I do things.

☐ ☐

I talk about how I do things in the workplace.

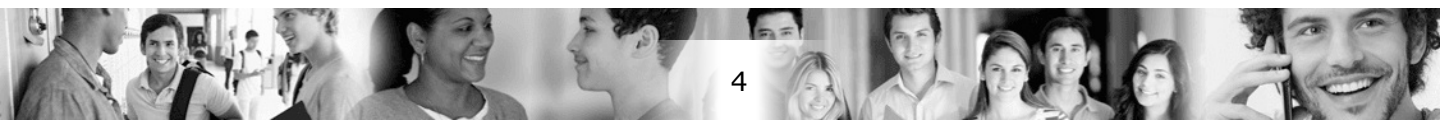
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I change subjects in a conversation.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to connect with** (verb): to communicate with someone using a telephone or computer network
e.g. I have successfully connected with some associates in Colombia.
- to hold a meeting** (expression): gathering people to discuss things and make decisions
e.g. I'm holding a meeting this week to discuss our events.
- access** (noun): having the opportunity or means to use something
e.g. Do you have access to a webcam?
- to cut expenses** (expression): to reduce the amount of money you spend on something
e.g. The boss is trying hard to cut expenses.
- to host** (verb): to organize and be in charge of a party or event
e.g. We are going to host both events.
- simultaneously** (adverb): happening or done at the same time
e.g. Let's host the events simultaneously.
- to broadcast** (verb): to send out a programme or event to be received by radios or televisions
e.g. We could have a screen to broadcast the events.
- to head** (expression): to go in a particular direction
e.g. Hope your good luck will quickly head north.





Learning Points

Adverbs of Manner

Adverbs are words that are used mainly to modify verbs and tell us the way in which something happens.

Adverbs of manner, however, are used primarily to tell us how something happens.

1. Adverbs of manner are usually placed either after the main verb or after the object.

- *She has **carefully designed** a new plan for the company.*
- *He is **trying hard** to cut expenses.*
- *I am hoping that things will **quickly head** north. (or head north quickly)*

1. Adverbs of manner can be added to a verb to modify its meaning. Compare the following:

- *I have connected with some of our associates.*

vs.

- *I have **successfully** connected with some of our associates.*

1. Adverbs of manner can not be put between a verb and its direct object.

- ~~*I think we should host simultaneously the events.*~~
- *I think we should host the events simultaneously.*

Expressions for Changing Topics in Oral Conversations

When speaking a foreign language, especially English, it is important that you acquire a set of conversation strategies which will help you deal with the spontaneity of spoken English. A very important strategy you need to master is changing topics in a conversation. Here are a few expressions you can use to change the subject of a conversation.

- *Let's catch up on that later / tomorrow / in a few hours.*
- *Now, to change the subject ...*
- *Oh, that reminds me ...*
- *Hold on to that question / thought / idea, but ...*
- *Oh, before I forget, ...*

Examples:

- A: *So, how's the new position?*

B: *Busy, **but let's catch up on that later.** Tell me about your new job.*

- A: *I'm holding a meeting next week to ...*

B: ***Oh, before I forget** ... next week's meeting has been cancelled.*

A: ***Now to change the subject,** have you contacted the office regarding the details for the party?*

